



## GAME RULES

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### PART 9: PREPARING FOR BATTLE

#### OGÓLNE

#### 9.1 ARMY BUILDING

Every battle begins long before the first shot is fired. Players will build an army using two resources: Minerals, which are used for Units and Upgrades, and Vespene Gas, which is used for Tactical Cards.

##### 9.1.1 Engagement Scale

##### 9.1.2 Selecting Race and Faction

##### 9.1.3 Minerals

##### 9.1.4 Vespene Gas

Spend Vespene Gas exclusively on Tactical Cards. It **cannot** be converted into Minerals. Unspent Vespene Gas is lost.

**EXAMPLE:** At Standard scale (2,000 Minerals), players have 200 Vespene Gas (10%) to spend on Tactical Cards.

##### 9.1.5 Tactical Cards and Army Slots

Tactical Cards unlock additional **Army Slots** (Core, Elite, Support, Air, Hero) beyond those provided by the **Faction Card**. Tactical Cards may be purchased with Vespene Gas to increase the number of available slots. All Tactical Cards and the **Faction Card** are set face-up on the table before the game begins.

Consult the Army Reference section (Part [12.11](#)) for each **Tactical Card's** [Vespene Gas](#) Costs.

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If a **Tactical Card** is marked as **Unique**, only one copy may be included in the army.

**EXAMPLE:** A **Barracks** card opens additional Core slots for [Marine Units](#). An **Academy** card opens Support slots for Medics.

### 9.1.6 Mustering Units

Fill available **Army Slots** with eligible [Units](#). Consult the Army Reference section (Part [12.12](#)) for each Unit's available **Composition Options**. Each Composition Option lists a model count and its corresponding **Mineral Cost**. The player must select one Composition Option per Unit, which determines the number of [models](#) in the Unit and its starting [Supply Value](#), as shown on the **Unit Card's Supply Profile**. A player cannot field a Unit at a model count that does not appear as a Composition Option. Each Unit occupies a number of **Army Slots** equal to its starting [Supply Value](#). Pay the Mineral Cost for every Unit recruited. Unused **Army Slots** are lost.

Consult the Army Reference section (Part [12.10](#)) for each Unit's available Composition Options and Mineral Costs.

**EXAMPLE:** A [Zerg](#) player chooses [Kerrigan's Swarm](#) as their **Faction Card**, which provides them with 2 Elite **Army Slots**. The player can recruit one small [Hydralisk](#) Unit, as its [Supply Value](#) indicates that it occupies exactly 2 Elite **Army Slots**. If the player wishes to include a full-strength [Hydralisk](#) Unit instead, it will occupy 3 Elite **Army Slots**. Therefore, the player must add any **Tactical Card** to their army that provides an additional Elite [Army Slot](#) as needed.

### 9.1.7 Purchasing Upgrades

Each **Unit Card** displays available upgrades on its reverse side. During [Army Building](#), a player may purchase any number of upgrades listed for that Unit, paying the listed cost for each. There is no limit to how many upgrades a Unit may have, provided each is a different entry on the card.

A purchased upgrade applies to **every** model in the Unit unless it has the [SPECIALIST](#) keyword. If the upgrade adds a new weapon or ability, all [models](#) gain it. If the entry shows † **FOR [Weapon Name]**, it is a replacement; every model carrying the named weapon loses it entirely and gains the upgrade weapon instead.

[SPECIALIST](#) upgrades work differently. Only **one** model in the Unit may carry

each **SPECIALIST** upgrade. The player nominates which model receives it during **Army Building**; all other **models** keep their original equipment. A Unit may not purchase the same **SPECIALIST** upgrade more than once, can buy two or more **different SPECIALIST** upgrades, each assigned **different** nominated model.

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Since a nominated model now carries a different weapon from the rest of the Unit, it resolves its attacks as a separate Batch during the Attack Sequence (Part **8.7.3**).

**EXAMPLE:** A player purchases a Rocket Launcher (**SPECIALIST**) and an AGG-12 (**SPECIALIST**, ↑ FOR C-14 Rifle) for a Unit of 6 Marines. One **Marine** is nominated to carry the Rocket Launcher alongside the C-14 Rifle. A second **Marine** is nominated to carry the AGG-12, losing their C-14 Rifle. The remaining 4 Marines keep their C-14 Rifles.

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### 9.1.8 Team Games



In multiplayer games (2v2, 3v3, Free-For-All), agree on a Total Mineral Value per team. Teams divide the budget among players as they wish, provided the team's total remains **within** the allowed limits. Each player builds their own army independently, selecting their own Faction Card and **Tactical Cards**. Teammates may choose the same or different Races.

### 9.1.9 Summoned Units



Some **Units**, such as the Roachling, Point Defence Drone, and Pylon, have no Mineral Cost. These are **Summoned Units**:

- They are not included in the **Army List** during **army building** and do not occupy any **Army Slots**.
- They are not in **Reserves** at the start of the game.
- **Summoned Units** cannot be deployed using the regular **deployment** rules. They are deployed only when a **Special Ability**, such as **SUMMON**, specifically puts them on the battlefield.
- Once on the battlefield, treat them as **Friendly Units** for all rule purposes unless stated otherwise.
- **Summoned Units** are not used for **The Final Score**.

- Once on the battlefield, a Summoned Unit's [Current Supply Value](#) counts towards the player's **Total Current Supply** on the battlefield.

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### 9.1.10 Army Roster Visibility

**Tournament Override:** Organised tournaments may use their own roster visibility rules, which override the default rules below. Always check the Tournament Organiser's rules pack before attending.

#### Default: Open Lists

By default, both players share their entire army rosters - including all Unit selections, upgrades, and weapon swaps with each other before the game starts. Since [Tactical Cards](#) and the **Faction Card** are already set face-up on the table, Open Lists go one step further by revealing exactly which [Units](#) and upgrades the opponent has selected. This enables both players to plan their strategy with full information and is the recommended way to play.

#### Optional: Closed Lists

Before the game begins, both players may agree to play with Closed Lists instead. If either player does not agree, default to Open Lists.

Under Closed Lists, army rosters are [hidden](#). Neither player is required to reveal their **Army List** or Unit upgrades before the game starts. The specific [Units](#) in a player's roster are discovered during play as they are deployed. However, all [Tactical Cards](#) and the **Faction Card** must still be set face-up on the table before the game begins. Both players may inspect each other's [Tactical Cards](#) and [Faction Cards](#) at any time.

Once a Unit is set on the battlefield, the [controlling player](#) must immediately inform the opponent of any upgrades or weapon swaps that the Unit carries. This includes replacement weapons purchased through the Upgrade system (Part [9.1.7](#)) or any other modifications that affect how the Unit behaves. The opponent is entitled to inspect the **Unit Card** and any associated [Tactical Cards](#) at any time while that Unit is on the table.

**Abathur's TIP:** While Open Lists are the default, we strongly recommend trying Closed Lists for the best StarCraft experience. The way [Units](#) are introduced to the battlefield one at a time mirrors the fog of war that defines StarCraft: you scout, you react, you adapt. Not knowing exactly what your opponent is fielding until it hits the table creates genuine tension and rewards sharp play. Before the first Unit ever hits the table, take a look at your opponent's [Tactical Cards](#) and **Faction Card**. Each **Tactical Card** has its own set of **Army Slots**: Core, Elite, Support, Air, and Hero. These slots determine which [Units](#) can occupy them. By studying what's on the table, an experienced player can make an educated guess about which

Units are still viable in their opponent's roster. The Barracks **Tactical Card** suggests Marines and Marauders. The Spawning Pool **Tactical Card** suggests Zerglings. The Robotics Facility **Tactical Card** suggests and Immortals. Reading your opponent's Tactical Cards is your first scouting - just like in the video game.

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### 9.1.11 Representation and Disclosure

All models should, where possible, accurately depict the weapons and equipment listed on their **Unit Card**. A Marine equipped with an AGG-12 should carry that weapon on the model, not a standard C-14 Rifle. Accurate modelling allows both players to identify each model's loadout at a glance.

Where a model does not accurately represent its equipment - such as a model awaiting conversion, or a Unit carrying weapon swaps that are not visually distinct - the controlling player is obliged to declare all non-represented upgrades and equipment the moment that Unit is deployed to the battlefield. Furthermore, the controlling player must remind their opponent of any such differences before any action where this information could be relevant - including, but not limited to, declaring Charge targets, selecting Shooting targets, or committing to a critical activation.

Both players have the right to full and accurate knowledge of all equipment on the battlefield at all times. Failing to disclose non-represented upgrades or equipment is considered unsportsmanlike conduct.

## 9.2 MISSION SELECTION AND THE DRAFT

Before the game starts, players use a short draft to determine the Mission and Deployment for the battle. The draft ensures neither player enters with a pre-arranged advantage - both sides have equal say in what is played and where.

### WHAT YOU NEED

Each player brings 2 Mission Cards and 2 Deployment Cards to the table. A player may not bring duplicate cards in their own set, although both players may independently bring the same cards as each other.

Arrange all cards face-up in two rows:

- Row 1: Mission Cards
- Row 2: Deployment Cards

## STEP 1 - ROLL-OFF

Both players Roll-Off (Part [3.2](#)). The winner makes two choices, in order:

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- **Choice 1 - Colour:** Declare yourself the Red Player or the Blue Player. This determines your [Entry Edge](#), [Zone of Influence](#), and **Mission Marker** affinity for the entire game.

- **Choice 2 - Draft Control:** Choose to control either the **Mission Draft** or the [Deployment Draft](#). Your opponent automatically controls the other.

**Abathur's TIP:** Controlling the **Mission Draft** secures the victory conditions that suit your army. Controlling the [Deployment Draft](#) shapes the geometry of the battlefield - tight [deployment](#) zones favour melee armies; spread-out zones favour ranged ones.

## STEP 2 - RESOLVE THE MISSION DRAFT

- The player without **Mission Draft** control removes any 2 [Mission Cards](#) from the table.
- The player with **Mission Draft** control selects 1 of the 2 remaining cards. This becomes the Mission for the game. Discard the last card.

## STEP 3 - RESOLVE THE [DEPLOYMENT DRAFT](#)

Repeat the same process for the [Deployment Cards](#):

- The player without [Deployment Draft](#) control removes any 2 [Deployment Cards](#) from the table.
- The player with [Deployment Draft](#) control selects 1 of the 2 remaining cards. This becomes the [Deployment](#) for the game. Discard the last card.

## STEP 4 - MARKER AFFINITY

Once both cards are chosen, assign [Mission Markers](#)' affinity according to the Marker number.

Marker Affinity:

- [Markers](#) 1 and 3 are associated with the Red Player.
- [Markers](#) 2 and 4 are associated with the Blue Player.
- Marker 5 begins Neutral.

Marker affinity indicates which player's colour is printed on each Marker. It does not grant starting control.

Proceed to [Battlefield Setup](#) (Part [9.3](#)).

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### 9.2.1 Mission and Deployment Card Details

[Mission Cards](#) define the game's victory conditions and pacing. Each **Mission Card** details Timing Windows for triggered rules, the **Starting Supply** and **Escalation** values that control the rate at which armies grow, the Game Length (usually 5 rounds), and any Additional Conditions such as [instant](#) win scenarios.

[Deployment Cards](#) define the battlefield's physical layout. Each [Deployment Card](#) details the battlefield dimensions, the coordinates for [Mission Markers](#) 1 through 5, the **Entry Edge** definitions for each player, and the [Zone of Influence](#), which extends 6" inward from each player's [Entry Edge](#).

## 9.3 BATTLEFIELD SETUP

Once the draft is complete and both cards have been chosen, the battlefield is set up in the following order.

- First, confirm the table dimensions as specified on the selected [Deployment Card](#).
- Second, assign **Entry Edges** to each player as indicated on the [Deployment Card](#).
- Third, set [Zone of Influence Markers](#) at the corners of each player's [Entry Edge](#) where the [Entry Edge](#) does not run the full length of a table edge, exactly as instructed by the [Deployment Card](#).
- Fourth, set [Mission Markers](#) at the coordinates listed on the selected [Deployment Card](#).
- Finally, set terrain by either selecting or rolling for one of the pre-made maps on the last pages of the rulebook, or starting with the Red Player, players alternate placing one terrain piece at a time based on the terrain density guide below.

### Terrain Density Guidelines

A balanced battlefield requires enough terrain for tactical choices without restricting movement or blocking sight lines. The following guidelines apply to a **Standard (36" x 54")** table and should be scaled proportionally for other sizes.

**Recommended Terrain Count:** 8 to 12 pieces total, distributed as follows:

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- 0 to 2 pieces of Size 0 (scatter terrain).
- 2 to 4 pieces of Size 1 (barricades, low walls, scatter crates). These provide Cover for infantry but do not block Line of Sight for anything larger than Size 1 models.
- 6 to 8 pieces of Size 2 (ruins, bunkers, wrecked vehicles). These form the backbone of the table, blocking LoS for most standard Units and creating the fire lanes and chokepoints that define the game.
- (If available) 1 to 2 pieces of Size 3+. These create HIGH GROUND positions and block LoS for almost everything. Too many of these make ranged combat nearly impossible; too few leave the table feeling flat.
- 4 to 6 pieces of Grass (Size 2 special). These do not block movement but provide a natural LoS cover for Units advancing across open ground.

**Distribution:** Divide the table visually into four quarters. Each quarter should contain at least 2 significant pieces (Size 2 or larger). No quarter should be completely empty, and none should be so dense that Units cannot manoeuvre through it.

**The Centre:** The area Within 6" of the table centre should contain at least one significant terrain piece. An empty centre creates a kill zone that punishes whoever moves first and can stall the game. Conversely, a completely blocked centre forces all engagements to the flanks.

**Fire Lanes:** Ensure that at least 2 clear fire lanes of 6" or wider exist, running roughly from one Entry Edge towards the other. Without fire lanes, ranged Units have no role, and melee armies dominate unchecked.

**Access Points:** Every piece of Size 3+ terrain that models can stand on should have at least one ACCESS POINT reachable from GROUND LEVEL without passing through another Size 2+ terrain piece. Elevated positions that are unreachable waste table space.

**Abathur's TIP:** The placement of terrain is the very first strategic move of the game, made before any miniature is set on the board. If you have a force that excels at ranged combat, position your tall blocking terrain pieces towards the centre to block fire lanes along the edges and direct melee armies into confined spaces. If your force is better at close-range combat, manipulate the terrain to create opportunities for sneaky movements unseen by ranged fire. Always consider the Mission Markers; placing terrain near a Marker makes it easier to hold with Cover, while leaving a Marker exposed likely benefits those with the most aggressive ranged fire.



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